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UAE Presidential Court

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday received Saudi Defence Minister Prince Khalid Bin Salman. The two sides exchanged views on regional developments with the aim of contributing to strengthening security and stability and achieving lasting peace in the region. The meeting was attended by Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court; Sheikh Tahnoon Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Ruler of Abu Dhabi and National Security Adviser.

Egypt pledges 'all support' to Riyadh

PARLIAMENT WEIGHS MILITARY AID AMID HOUTHI ATTACKS

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Egypt pledged yesterday to provide Saudi Arabia with all necessary support to defend its security and stability, as fresh Houthi missile and drone attacks targeted the kingdom and Cairo's parliament debated possible military assistance.

The Egyptian presidency said Cairo would intensify diplomatic efforts to ease regional tensions, even as President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi sought parliamentary approval to help defend Saudi Arabia if requested.

The move marks a potentially significant shift in Egypt's cautious regional policy as the conflict between Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi militants and the Saudi-led coalition intensifies.

Six injured in attack

Saudi air defences intercepted two ballistic missiles targeting Khamis Mushayt and a drone over Riyadh early yesterday, coalition officials said.

Meanwhile, six people were injured when a projectile launched by Yemen's Houthi militia struck a residential area in Saudi Arabia's Najran yesterday the kingdom's Civil Defence said. The attack also damaged three homes and three vehicles. Authorities condemned the targeting of civilian areas as a flagrant violation of international humanitarian law.

Egypt's National Defence Council, chaired by Al Sissi, approved providing Saudi Arabia with all necessary and possible support to protect its security, territorial integrity, resources and Islamic holy sites.

Egyptian lawmaker Mostafa Bakry said the council had approved sending troops to Saudi Arabia on a defensive mission. However, the official presidential statement did not explicitly mention troop deployment.

Parliament delays vote

Egypt's parliament postponed a vote on Al Sissi's request to authorise military support for Saudi Arabia, with deliberations expected to resume today.

Lawmakers were reported to be broadly supportive of the proposal, although the nature of any military assistance remained unclear.

Under Egypt's constitution, sending troops on combat missions abroad requires consultation with the National Defence Council and approval by two-thirds of parliament.

Al Sissi insisted Egypt was not seeking confrontation. "We are speaking only about defence," he said on Saturday, describing Saudi Arabia's security as vital to regional stability.

Houthis warn Cairo

The Houthis warned Egypt against military involvement, saying such a move could threaten its national security and stability. The warning came as the militia intensified attacks on Saudi Arabia, including strikes against energy facilities and Riyadh's international airport.

GARGASH DENOUNCES ONLINE INSULTS

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has called for an end to insults and hostile exchanges between Gulf voices on social media, warning that such behaviour does not reflect the region's values and principles.

In a post on X, Gargash urged people across the Gulf to rise above the offensive language and personal attacks increasingly seen in online exchanges, stressing that everyone has a responsibility to reject such conduct.

"Rising above the vulgarity and offensive exchanges we are witnessing in Gulf disputes on social media is a duty for all of us," Gargash wrote. "This language does not represent us, nor does it reflect our morals and values."

The UAE presidential adviser warned that the region was going through a critical period requiring greater awareness and responsibility from everyone. "We are going through a pivotal period that demands awareness and responsibility from us all. We may differ in our assessment."

—Gulf News Report

Dubai economy hits Dh473b in H1 2026

Banking, health care, technology and construction support economy

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai's economy reached Dh473 billion in the first half of 2026, supported by strong growth in banking, health care, technology and construction, highlighting the emirate's diverse economic strengths amid global challenges.

Figures released on Saturday by the Dubai Data and Statistics Establishment at Digital Dubai showed that financial and insurance activities grew 8.8 per cent, accounting for 14 per cent of the economy.

Health care and social work recorded even faster growth of 14.3 per cent, the highest among the major expanding sectors. Construction expanded 2.4 per cent, while information and communication activities grew 2.7 per cent. Electricity, water supply and waste management activities increased 5.4 per cent.

Dubai's economic strengths

Wholesale and retail trade remained Dubai's largest economic activity, accounting for 20.5 per cent of GDP, followed by financial and insurance services at 14 per cent and real estate at 11.8 per cent. Trade remained a major contributor to economic activity across Dubai.

The emirate's total economic output stood at Dh505 billion when measured at current prices, up 0.2 per cent from a year earlier.

Helal Saeed Almarri, Director General of the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism, said continued growth across several strategic sectors demonstrated the strength of Dubai's economic foundations.

Hamad Obaid Al Mansoori, Director General of Digital Dubai, highlighted the importance of digital transformation and artificial intelligence in improving productivity and creating new economic opportunities.

SEE ALSO P-I

ABU DHABI-ARAB TRADE EXCEEDS DH87 BILLION

Abu Dhabi's non-oil foreign trade with Arab countries exceeded Dh87 billion in the first seven months of 2026, according to figures from the Statistics Centre – Abu Dhabi (SCAD).

Exports to Arab markets reached Dh30.4 billion, while re-exports totalled Dh32.8 billion and imports stood at Dh24.4 billion.

Arab countries remained major trading partners, ranking as Abu Dhabi's leading export destinations in January, February, June and July. They ranked second in March and May, and third in April. Arab markets also led re-exports throughout the seven-month period, reflecting their importance to Abu Dhabi's regional trade and commercial links.

—Abdulla Rasheed, Abu Dhabi Editor

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